

// PROPOSAL · WEBSITE REDESIGN RFP OF SEPTEMBER 22, 2026

A polished, easy-to-run website for Onward! A Legacy Foundation

You asked for a site that clearly explains what Onward! does, takes applications easily, keeps a private area for the board, and stays in your staff's hands. We built a working concept first so you can judge the result, not just the promise.

Prepared for

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Prepared by

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Submitted

**October 2026
Concept:
williamsdigital.io/preview/o
nward-foundation**

01 · SUMMARY

The whole proposal in one minute

Williams Digital will redesign onwardfoundation.org on WordPress, move your website and email off Turbify without interrupting your mail, and train your staff to run it, for the \$5,000 the board has budgeted.

\$5,000

Fixed price,
itemized below.
No overage
billing.

Dec 18

Target launch,
ahead of
scholarship
season opening
January 1.

WordPress

Stays. Your
content, your
Gravity Forms
and your logins
carry over.

**\$200 to
\$320**

Estimated yearly
hosting and
email, against
about \$400
today.

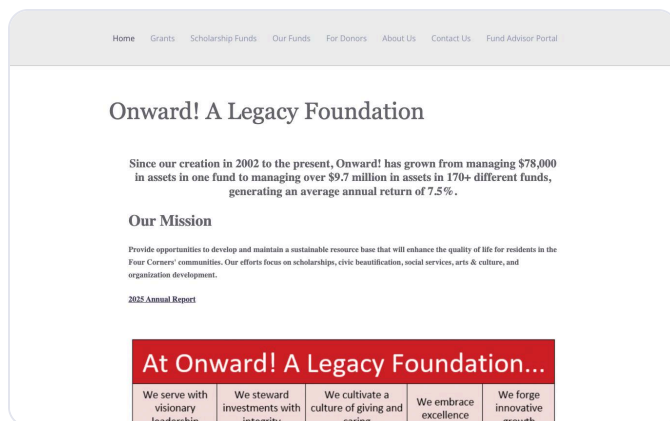
What is different about this proposal

The concept linked here is already built with Onward!'s own words, funds, scholarships and photographs. It includes a searchable directory of 105 funds, a scholarship finder, a one-form application demo and a private board area. Please click through it on a phone.

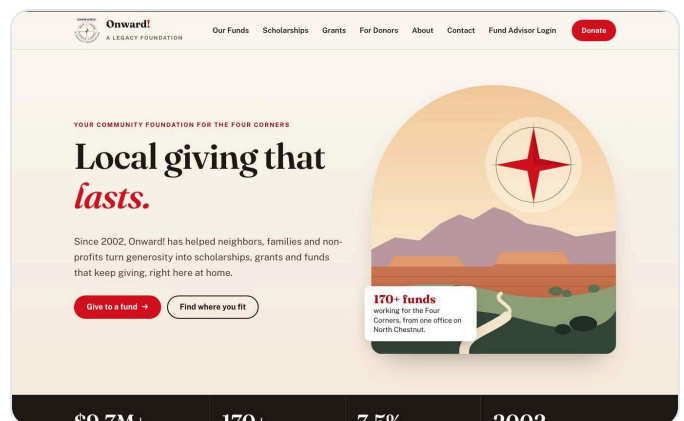
02 • THE CONCEPT

See it before you decide

Every page below is live and clickable. It is a design concept, so forms do not send and nothing replaces your current site.



Today: onwardfoundation.org



Concept: the same content, redesigned

Home page

Five clear paths: give, start a fund,
scholarships, grants, fiscal sponsorship

Our Funds

105 funds, searchable and filterable by type

Scholarships

Finder by school and field, plus a one-form application demo

Grants

Cycle dates that update themselves, criteria, documents, awardees

Board & staff portal

Private area demo. Password: onward2026

Contact & newsletter

Routed contact form and Mailchimp sign-up

The landscape illustration and icons were drawn for this concept as an example of the illustration work in the scope. Photographs are Onward!'s own, from the current site.

03 • WHAT WE FOUND

We read all 66 pages of the current site

These are the things a redesign should fix, and the things worth keeping.

Visitors have to know your vocabulary

Agency, donor advised, endowment, fiscal and specific interest funds are each on their own page with no guide to which one a visitor needs. The concept leads with who the visitor is.

Funds are maintained by hand on long pages

The Fiscal Projects page lists 56 projects on a single page. Adding one means editing that page. In the redesign each fund is its own short entry, and the lists build themselves.

Students apply more than once

Most scholarships need a general application plus a separate form for each scholarship. One form with a checklist of scholarships removes the repeat work for students and staff.

Search engines are getting an old map

Page addresses are numbers such as ?page_id=134, and the sitemap file dates from March 2018 and lists pages that no longer exist. Readable addresses and redirects fix this.

The site feels unfinished on a phone

The home page opens with large blocks of bold text and a cookie notice across the bottom of the screen. News posts stop in 2021 and the events calendar is empty.

Website, email and domain settings are tied together

All three sit with Turbify, which is why moving the website feels risky. We separate them first, so the website can move without touching email.

Keep: Gravity Forms

Your applications already run on Gravity Forms, with file uploads and save-and-continue. We restyle and reorganize them instead of rebuilding from zero.

Keep: your donation and fund advisor system

The Donate and Fund Advisor Login links to your accounting system stay exactly as they are, and become visible on every page.

Everything in your RFP, and how we deliver it

YOU ASKED FOR	WHAT YOU GET
Content strategy	A reorganized sitemap built around five audiences (donors, fund starters, students, non-profits, community projects). Your current sitemap is the starting point, with changes agreed before design begins.
Copywriting	Home, fund types, giving, scholarships, grants, fiscal sponsorship and about pages rewritten in plain language from your existing content and a one-hour interview. Fund and scholarship descriptions are carried over and lightly edited.
Illustration & information design	A Four Corners landscape illustration, an icon set, and diagrams for “which fund is right for me” and the grant cycle.
Visual design	A design system in Onward!’s red and black: type, color, buttons, cards and page templates, using your photographs.
Front-end & back-end coding	A lightweight custom WordPress theme. Funds and scholarships become structured entries, so staff fill in a short form and the directory, filters and counts update on their own.
Forms	Scholarship, grant, fiscal project, board update and contact forms reorganized in Gravity Forms, including the combined scholarship application.
Password-protected section	A board and staff area with individual logins, hidden from menus, search and search engines, for announcements, meeting packets and documents.
Integrations	Donate and Fund Advisor Login links to your accounting system on every page. Newsletter sign-up connected to your existing Mailchimp account.

YOU ASKED FOR	WHAT YOU GET
Search engine optimization	Readable page addresses, redirects from every old address, page titles and descriptions, a current sitemap, image descriptions, and Google Search Console set up in Onward!'s name.
Mobile optimization	Designed for phones first and tested on real iPhone and Android browsers. See section 08.
Accessibility	Built to WCAG 2.1 AA: readable contrast, keyboard access, labeled forms. Your RFP page asks for an accessible site, so this is included rather than optional.
Hosting move	Website and email moved off Turbify with a staged plan. See section 05.
Staff training	Two recorded video sessions and a written guide with screenshots: adding a fund, opening and closing an application, posting news, updating the board area.

Not included: new photography, a logo redesign, and changes inside your accounting system or Mailchimp account beyond connecting them.

05 • HOSTING AND EMAIL

Moving off Turbify without losing a single email

You said email cannot go down. So the website and the email move on different days, and the old mailboxes stay switched on until the new ones are proven.

1

Inventory

We list every mailbox, alias and forwarder with your staff. You mentioned 1,000 is more than you need, so this is also where the right number is decided.

2

Take control of the domain settings

The domain's settings are copied, record for record, to an independent service. Nothing changes for anyone, but from this point the website and the email can move separately.

- 3 Build the new mailboxes and copy the mail across**
New mailboxes are created and existing mail is copied in the background while everyone keeps working in the old ones.
- 4 Switch email on a Friday evening**
New mail starts arriving in the new mailboxes. A final copy picks up anything received during the switch. Staff get a one-page sign-in sheet and we are on call Monday morning.
- 5 Protect your sending reputation**
The records that tell other mail systems your messages are genuine (SPF, DKIM and DMARC) are set up, so grant and scholarship emails reach inboxes.
- 6 Launch the website on its own day**
The new site goes live separately. If anything is off, it can be pointed back within minutes without affecting email.
- 7 Keep Turbify for 30 days, then cancel**
The old account stays as a fallback until everyone confirms nothing is missing.

What it will cost each year

ITEM	RECOMMENDED	ESTIMATED PER YEAR
Email	Google Workspace for Nonprofits, or Microsoft 365 for nonprofits if staff prefer Outlook Both offer no-cost plans to eligible 501(c)(3) organizations. We handle the application.	\$0
Website hosting	Managed WordPress hosting with daily backups, a security certificate and a private test copy of the site	\$180 to \$300
Domain registration	onwardfoundation.org, kept in Onward!'s own name	About \$20
Estimated total, against about \$400 today		\$200 to \$320

These are estimates. Exact quotes, and confirmation of nonprofit eligibility, are delivered in week one before anything is purchased. Every account is opened in Onward!'s name and paid by Onward! directly, so you are never dependent on us for access.

Live before the end of the year

This schedule assumes a decision by Friday, October 23. If the decision comes later, each date moves by the same number of days. The concept already built shortens the design phase.

WHEN	MILESTONE	MAJOR TASKS
Oct 26 to Nov 6 Weeks 1 and 2	Kickoff and content plan	Kickoff call. Staff interview. Final sitemap. Mailbox inventory. Hosting and email quotes. Domain settings moved to independent control. You approve: sitemap and hosting choice.
Nov 9 to Nov 20 Weeks 3 and 4	Design and copy	Concept refined into final designs for every page type. Rewritten copy delivered for review. Illustration and icon set completed. You approve: design and copy, with two rounds of revisions.
Nov 23 to Dec 4 Weeks 5 and 6	Build	WordPress theme built on a private test copy. Funds and scholarships loaded as entries. Forms reorganized. Board area set up. Email switched on Friday, December 4.
Dec 7 to Dec 11 Week 7	Review and training	Staff review on the test copy. Phone, tablet and accessibility testing. Redirects from old addresses. Two recorded training sessions. You approve: launch.
Dec 14 to Dec 18 Week 8	Launch	New site goes live. Search Console and sitemap submitted. Scholarship forms tested end to end before they open January 1.

WHEN	MILESTONE	MAJOR TASKS
Through Jan 18	30 days of support	Fixes, questions and small adjustments at no charge. Turbify account cancelled once everything is confirmed.

What we need from Onward!

One point of contact, feedback within three business days at each approval, administrator access to WordPress and Turbify, and a one-hour interview in week one.

07 • BUDGET

Project budget by line item

LINE ITEM	COST
Discovery, content strategy and sitemap Kickoff, staff interview, content audit of all 66 pages, final sitemap	\$500
Copywriting and content migration Core pages rewritten; fund, scholarship and document content moved and tidied	\$700
Visual design, illustration and information design Design system, page designs, illustration, icons, diagrams	\$900
WordPress development, front end and back end Custom theme, fund and scholarship entries, directory, finder, responsive build, accessibility	\$1,200
Forms and applications Combined scholarship application, grant, fiscal project, board update and contact forms	\$500
Password-protected board and staff area	\$250

LINE ITEM	COST
Integrations Donation and fund advisor links, Mailchimp sign-up	\$150
Search engine optimization Readable addresses, redirects, titles and descriptions, sitemap, Search Console	\$250
Hosting and email migration Inventory, domain settings, mailbox move, website move, 30-day fallback	\$350
Staff training and 30 days of support Two recorded sessions, written guide, post-launch fixes	\$200
Total, fixed price	\$5,000

Payment

50% (\$2,500) at kickoff and 50% (\$2,500) at launch. Ongoing hosting is paid by Onward! directly to the providers and is not part of this total, as your RFP specifies.

After launch

Nothing further is required: the site is built for your staff to run. If you would like someone on call for updates and security patches, an optional care plan is \$50 a month and can be cancelled at any time.

08 • MOBILE AND RESPONSIVE PLAN

Designed on a phone first

A student checking a deadline or a donor following a link from Facebook will most likely be on a phone. Each page is designed at phone width first, then widened for tablets and desktops.

- **Layouts that reflow, not shrink.** Card grids become swipe rows, tables become stacked cards, and the menu becomes a single clearly labeled Menu button.
- **Thumb-sized targets.** Every button and link is at least 44 pixels tall.
- **Tested on real browsers.** iPhone Safari, Android Chrome, a small 320-pixel screen, tablet and desktop, with a written checklist per page.
- **Readable by everyone.** WCAG 2.1 AA contrast, text that can be enlarged to 200%, and full keyboard and screen reader access.

- **Forms that work on a phone.** Large fields, the right keyboard for email and phone numbers, and saved progress so a long application can be finished later.
- **Fast on a rural connection.** Compressed images that load as you scroll, no heavy page-builder code, and a target of under two seconds to first view on 4G.
- **One donate button always in reach.** On phones a single bar with Donate and Contact stays at the bottom of the screen.
- **Staff can preview before publishing.** WordPress shows the phone view of any page before it goes live.

The concept site already follows this plan. Open it on your own phone to check.

Examples of similarly complex work

Each of these is live and shares something specific with your project: staff who publish for themselves, online applications, a document library, or a private area.

COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION • LIVE

Vestlake Communities at Liberty Park

The official website for a homeowners association in Vestavia Hills, Alabama: events calendar, newsletter archive, a document library for bylaws, minutes and financials, and an admin the management team runs themselves.

Why it is relevant: a board-governed organization whose staff publish without technical help. vestlakelibertypark.com

DIRECTORY AND APPLICATIONS • LIVE

Buy Auburn

A national directory of Auburn-owned businesses. Businesses apply online, an administrator approves them from a dashboard, and listings are searchable by state, city and industry.

Why it is relevant: online applications with a review step, and a searchable directory like your funds list. buyauburn.com

OWNER-MANAGED WEBSITE • LIVE

WeAddALogo

An embroidery and printing shop in Leeds, Alabama. The owner adds, hides and reprices her own products, and larger jobs come in through a custom-order form with file upload.

Why it is relevant: a non-technical owner maintaining her own site, and forms with file uploads. weaddalogo.com

BOOKING REQUESTS AND DASHBOARD • LIVE

Vardar Transportation

A Birmingham transportation company. Every booking request lands in a private owner dashboard where it can be accepted or declined, with email alerts to the owners.

Why it is relevant: public forms feeding a private, signed-in area. vardartransportation.com

A note on platform: these four sites are hand-coded rather than WordPress, because that suited those clients. Your site will be WordPress, as your RFP specifies, built as a standard theme that any WordPress developer could take over.

References from previous clients

Three clients whose projects are closest to yours. A contact name, email and phone number for each is in the email that accompanied this proposal.

Vestlake Communities at Liberty Park

Community association
management team
Website, document library
and staff admin

Buy Auburn

Auburn Business Network
Directory, applications and
admin approvals

WeAddALogo

Owner, Leeds, Alabama
Owner-managed website
and order forms

// ABOUT WILLIAMS DIGITAL

Who you would be working with

Dylan Williams is an Alabama-based developer, Auburn University Computer Science Engineering graduate, and technology professional with more than 10 years of experience supporting large-scale productions, digital platforms, and user experiences.

Williams Digital is a small studio in Birmingham, Alabama. You work with Dylan directly from kickoff to training. We are not in Colorado, so meetings are by video call and every training session is recorded for future staff.

Questions before October 15 are welcome: Dylan@williamsdigital.io or (205) 202-9193.

This proposal and the concept site were prepared independently by Williams Digital in response to Onward! A Legacy Foundation's public request for proposals. Pricing is valid for 60 days.